

LAYER 1

The Elements

Three types of elements, three different value rules. The foundation of everything that follows.

THE PRISMATIC SYSTEM

What Are Elements?

The Prismatic System is built on three types of elements. Each type looks different and calculates its value differently from its rank number.

Every element has two properties:

1. A TYPE — which determines the value rule (Glyph, Ring, or Shard)
2. A RANK — a number used to calculate the value

The same rank produces completely different values depending on the type.



GLYPH

Value = Rank

Glyph₁ = 1

Glyph₃ = 3

Glyph₆ = 6



RING

Value = Rank × 2

Ring₁ = 2

Ring₃ = 6

Ring₆ = 12



SHARD

Value = Rank²

Shard₁ = 1

Shard₃ = 9

Shard₄ = 16

Glyphs $\triangle$ — Value = Rank

Glyphs are the simplest elements. Represented by triangles. A Glyph's value is just its rank number. There are 6 Glyphs, ranked 1 through 6.

What you see is what you get — no calculation needed.

Glyph₁ = 1

Glyph₄ = 4

Glyph₆ = 6

Practice: What are the values of Glyph₂ and Glyph₅?

Glyph₂ = 2 | Glyph₅ = 5

Glyphs will appear frequently because intermediate results in Chains always become Glyphs (you'll learn why in Layer 4).

Rings ○ — Value = Rank × 2

Rings are represented by circles. They scale faster than Glyphs because their value is double their rank. There are 6 Rings, ranked 1 through 6.

$$\text{Ring}_1 = 1 \times 2 = 2$$

$$\text{Ring}_3 = 3 \times 2 = 6$$

$$\text{Ring}_6 = 6 \times 2 = 12$$

Practice: What are the values of Ring_2 and Ring_5 ?

$$\text{Ring}_2 = 2 \times 2 = 4$$

$$| \quad \text{Ring}_5 = 5 \times 2 = 10$$



Ring₃ has value 6 and Glyph₆ also has value 6. Same value, different types. This distinction will matter in Layer 2.

Shards ◇ — Value = Rank²

Shards are the most powerful elements. Represented by diamonds. Their value equals their rank squared. There are only 4 Shards, ranked 1 through 4.

$$\text{Shard}_1 = 1^2 = 1 \quad \text{Shard}_2 = 2^2 = 4 \quad \text{Shard}_3 = 3^2 = 9 \quad \text{Shard}_4 = 4^2 = 16$$

Because values grow quadratically, Shards produce the largest numbers. Shard₄ at 16 is the single most valuable element in the entire system.

Quick check: Glyph₄, Ring₂, and Shard₂ all have the same value. What is it?

All three = 4. But they are three DIFFERENT elements. Type always matters.

Layer 1 Summary & Practice

Three element types, three value rules:

GLYPH: Value = Rank (simple, linear)

RING: Value = Rank $\times$ 2 (doubled, grows faster)

SHARD: Value = Rank² (squared, grows fastest)

Try these without looking back:

1. Glyph₃ = ?
2. Ring₄ = ?
3. Shard₁ = ?
4. Ring₆ = ?
5. Shard₃ = ?
6. Glyph₁ = ?

Answers: 1. 3 2. 8 3. 1 4. 12 5. 9 6. 1



Always determine TYPE first, then apply the correct value rule. Never guess — always calculate.